Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-10-29

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Song of Solomon 6:1-13

1 Where has your beloved gone, O fairest among women? Where has your beloved turned aside, That we may seek him with you?

2 My beloved has gone to his garden, To the beds of spices, To feed his flock in the gardens, And to gather lilies.

3 I am my beloved’s, And my beloved is mine. He feeds his flock among the lilies.

4 O my love, you are as beautiful as Tirzah, Lovely as Jerusalem, Awesome as an army with banners!

5 Turn your eyes away from me, For they have overcome me. Your hair is like a flock of goats Going down from Gilead.

6 Your teeth are like a flock of sheep Which have come up from the washing; Every one bears twins, And none is barren among them.

7 Like a piece of pomegranate Are your temples behind your veil.

8 There are sixty queens And eighty concubines, And virgins without number.

9 My dove, my perfect one, Is the only one, The only one of her mother, The favorite of the one who bore her. The daughters saw her And called her blessed, The queens and the concubines, And they praised her.

10 Who is she who looks forth as the morning, Fair as the moon, Clear as the sun, Awesome as an army with banners?

11 I went down to the garden of nuts To see the verdure of the valley, To see whether the vine had budded And the pomegranates had bloomed.

12 Before I was even aware, My soul had made me As the chariots of my noble people.

13 Return, return, O Shulamite; Return, return, that we may look upon you! What would you see in the Shulamite— As it were, the dance of the two camps?

II. Key Summary

• The daughters of Jerusalem ask, "Where has your beloved gone?" and offer to seek him with her; she answers that he has gone to his garden to feed his flock and gather lilies, and says, "I am my beloved's, and my beloved is mine." (vv. 1–3)

• The beloved says she is as beautiful as Tirzah, lovely as Jerusalem, awesome as an army with banners; he asks her to turn her eyes away, and compares her hair, teeth, and temples to a flock of goats, a flock of sheep, and a piece of pomegranate. (vv. 4–7)

• He says there are sixty queens, eighty concubines, and virgins without number, but his dove, his perfect one, is the only one; the daughters call her blessed and the queens and concubines praise her. Then come the words "I went down to the garden of nuts" to see the vine and the pomegranates, and finally the call, "Return, return, O Shulamite." (vv. 8–13)

III. Passage Analysis

"I Am My Beloved's" — The Order Is Reversed

> In Song of Solomon 2:16 the maiden said: My beloved is mine, and I am his. Here she says, I am my beloved's, and my beloved is mine. Some people note that in the first the emphasis is on what belongs to her; in the second the emphasis is on whom she belongs to. [1]

In 2:16 she starts with "My beloved is mine"; in 6:3 she flips the order and starts with "I am my beloved's." The daughters asked, "Where has your beloved gone?" She first says where he is (6:2). Then what she says out loud is whom she belongs to.

After the Separation, the Same Words

> These words of praise are the same as what Solomon said to her on their wedding night. [2]

The flock of goats, the sheep, and the pomegranate in verses 5–7 are the same pictures used in 4:1–3. Between those two passages stands 5:6: "My beloved had turned away and was gone." They were apart once, and when he speaks again, he says the very same words.

IV. Reflection Question

If you just had a falling-out with a close friend, how would you address them, and what would be the first thing you say when you see them next?

When the bride opened the door in 5:6, her beloved had already turned away and gone. When he speaks again in this passage, he repeats the words of 4:1–3, and he still calls her what he called her in 5:2: "My dove, my perfect one" (6:9).

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Commentary on Song of Solomon 6, https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/song-of-solomon-6/

[2] 華人基督徒查經資料網站, Song of Solomon 6 notes (《雷氏研讀本》, Chinese Ryrie Study Bible), https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/22Song/22GT06.htm